Committed Compliance Is Not the Same as Obedience

Kochanska's observational program distinguishes committed (willing) compliance from situational compliance; the former is more closely linked to later internalization, and neither is a moral verdict or a parenting score.

RADE: MODERATE-DISTINCTION; LOW-TECHNIQUE | STATUS: DRAFT | DOMAIN: BEHAVIOR, REGULATION | REPLICATION: VERIFIE

WHAT WE KNOW (Narrowest Supported Conclusion)

A toddler can follow a request because an adult is standing there, or because the child has taken the request as their own. Kochanska (1995) traced committed compliance—willing, self-regulated cooperation with a caregiver's agenda—as more closely related to later internalization of rules than situational, pressure-dependent compliance. Understanding a "no" and being able to inhibit an act are not the same achievement.

EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL ASSESSMENT

Home and laboratory observations in modest, culturally bounded samples. Longitudinal associations are compatible with child characteristics, relationship quality, and bidirectional effects. This is not an RCT of a discipline package. Adjacent Chapter 11: inhibitory-control-toddler.md is task suppression, not this relational distinction. Sleep and attachment-intervention cards are not restated.

EFFECT SIZE AND PERSISTENCE

The relevant object is not "obedience" as a single score. Context-specific stability is more defensible than a durable compliance trait. "Do" and "don't" contexts can diverge.

BIAS, HETEROGENEITY, AND CONFOUNDING

GI attenuation: untested-in-GI (mutually responsive orientation and compliance reflect both evocative child temperament and parental scaffolding; observational laboratory dyads lack genetically informed twin/adoption controls).

Language comprehension, fatigue, hearing, and cultural expectations about deference can be mistaken for defiance. Samples are often maternal and Western.

WHAT THIS DOES NOT MEAN (Strict Boundary Conditions)

Immediate compliance is not understanding, cooperation, conscience, or moral development. Noncompliance is not automatically a behavior problem. A failed "no" is not deficient parenting. Opposition can express agency, limited regulation, or communication difficulty.

WHAT ACTION IS REASONABLY JUSTIFIED

Treat "no" as communication that has to be cognitively and emotionally usable. A universal compliance script does not follow.

VERIFIED SOURCES & DOI IDENTIFIERS

- Kochanska (1995), Child Development